
Turn in 6

Grant Talbert

April 6, 2025

MA 542 Section A1

Boston University

Problem 1

Since $\sqrt[5]{7}, \zeta \sqrt[5]{7} \in E$, we have

$$\frac{\zeta \sqrt[5]{7}}{\sqrt[5]{7}} = \zeta \in E.$$

Therefore, $\mathbb{Q} \subseteq \mathbb{Q}(\zeta) \subseteq E$ is a chain of field extensions, and thus

$$[E : \mathbb{Q}(\zeta)] [\mathbb{Q}(\zeta) : \mathbb{Q}].$$

It suffices to compute these two smaller computations. Note that $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$ is generated by the set $Z := \{\zeta^i \mid 0 \leq i \leq 4, i \in \mathbb{N}\}$. Note also that ζ manifestly satisfies the equation $\zeta^5 - 1 = 0$, and that

$$\begin{aligned} (\zeta - 1)(\zeta^4 + \zeta^3 + \zeta^2 + \zeta + 1) &= \zeta^5 + \zeta^4 + \zeta^3 + \zeta^2 + \zeta - \zeta^4 - \zeta^3 - \zeta^2 - \zeta - 1 \\ &= \zeta^5 - 1 \\ &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

Since ζ is a primitive fifth root of unity, $\zeta \neq 1$, and thus $\zeta - 1 \neq 0$. Dividing by this, we find that

$$\zeta^4 + \zeta^3 + \zeta^2 + \zeta + 1 = 0.$$

Therefore, this set is not linearly independent. Moreover, since $\zeta^5 = 1$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} (\zeta^2)^4 + (\zeta^2)^3 + (\zeta^2)^2 + (\zeta^2) + 1 &= \zeta^8 + \zeta^6 + \zeta^4 + \zeta^2 + 1 = \zeta^3 + \zeta + \zeta^4 + \zeta^2 + 1 = 0, \\ (\zeta^3)^4 + (\zeta^3)^3 + (\zeta^3)^2 + (\zeta^3) + 1 &= \zeta^{12} + \zeta^9 + \zeta^6 + \zeta^3 + 1 = \zeta^2 + \zeta^4 + \zeta + \zeta^3 + 1 = 0, \\ (\zeta^4)^4 + (\zeta^4)^3 + (\zeta^4)^2 + (\zeta^4) + 1 &= \zeta^{16} + \zeta^{12} + \zeta^8 + \zeta^4 + 1 = \zeta + \zeta^2 + \zeta^3 + \zeta^4 + 1 = 0. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, $\{\zeta, \zeta^2, \zeta^3, \zeta^4\}$ form a set of four distinct roots of this polynomial. Since a polynomial in $\mathbb{Q}$ has at most 4 roots, these must be all roots of the polynomial. Since none of these roots are in $\mathbb{Q}$, we find that this polynomial is irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}$, and thus is the minimal polynomial of ζ . Since the polynomial has degree 4, $[\mathbb{Q}(\zeta) : \mathbb{Q}] = 4$.

Now consider E . Note that $x^5 - 7$ is clearly the minimal polynomial of $\sqrt[5]{7}$ over $\mathbb{Q}$. However, note that $x^5 - 7$ is also clearly irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$ as well, and thus is the minimal polynomial over $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$. Since E is the minimal field containing ζ and $\sqrt[5]{7}$, we find that $[E : \mathbb{Q}(\zeta)] = \deg(x^5 - 7) = 5$. Therefore,

$$[E : \mathbb{Q}] = 5 \cdot 4 = 20.$$

Problem 2

Let $K_6 = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$. The proof follows from our proof of the above problem.

Let $K_i = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta^i \sqrt[5]{7})$ for $1 \leq i \leq 5$. Since each $\zeta^i \sqrt[5]{7}$ is a root of $x^5 - 7$, which is by Eisenstein's criteria irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}$, we find that it is the minimal polynomial for each root over $\mathbb{Q}$, and thus $[\mathbb{Q}(\zeta^i \sqrt[5]{7}) : \mathbb{Q}] = \deg(x^5 - 7) = 5$.

Problem 3

Since each K_i for $1 \leq i \leq 5$ does not contain all roots of $x^5 - 7$, the polynomial does not split in K_i . Since this is the minimal polynomial for each of these roots, it follows that no polynomial that doesn't split in $\mathbb{Q}$ can split in these fields. Therefore, these fields are not splitting fields.

The field $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$ is a splitting field for $x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$, as shown previously. Therefore, it is a splitting field.

Problem 4

Since the degree of E is 20, and since E is clearly Galois as it has characteristic 0 and $x^5 - 7$ splits in it, we have $[E : \mathbb{Q}] = |\text{Gal}(E/\mathbb{Q})| = 20$. Since σ, τ are clearly well-defined as automorphisms by definition, they are elements of $\text{Gal}(E/\mathbb{Q})$. It suffices to show $|\langle \sigma, \tau \rangle| = 20$.

Note that $|\sigma| = 5$ trivially, as σ fixes all elements other than powers of $\sqrt[5]{7}$, and

$$\sigma^5(\sqrt[5]{7}) = \zeta^5 \sqrt[5]{7} = \sqrt[5]{7}.$$

Since this generates all other powers of $\sqrt[5]{7}$, it is easily seen that $|\sigma| = 5$. Similarly, τ fixes $\sqrt[5]{7}$, but it's action on ζ gives it order 4:

$$\begin{aligned} \tau(\zeta) &= \zeta^2, & \tau^2(\zeta) &= (\zeta^2)^2 = \zeta^4, \\ \tau^3(\zeta) &= (\zeta^4)^2 = \zeta^8, & \tau^4(\zeta) &= (\zeta^8)^2 = \zeta^{16} = \zeta. \end{aligned}$$

Next, note that

$$(\tau\sigma\tau^{-1})(\zeta) = \tau\tau^{-1}(\zeta) = \zeta,$$

since σ fixes ζ , and also note that

$$(\tau\sigma\tau^{-1})(\sqrt[5]{7}) = (\tau\sigma)(\sqrt[5]{7}) = \zeta^2 \sqrt[5]{7},$$

since τ fixes the radical, and thus so must it's inverse. Also notice that

$$\sigma^2(\zeta) = \zeta, \quad \sigma^2(\sqrt[5]{7}) = \zeta^2 \sqrt[5]{7}.$$

Therefore, $\sigma^2 = \tau\sigma\tau^{-1}$. Note that σ^2 generates $\langle \sigma \rangle$, since 2 doesn't divide 5. Therefore,

$$\tau \langle \sigma \rangle \tau^{-1} = \langle \sigma \rangle,$$

and thus we immediately have $\tau^n \langle \sigma \rangle \tau^{-n} = \langle \sigma \rangle$. It follows that $\langle \sigma \rangle$ is normal in $\langle \sigma, \tau \rangle$, and thus

$$\langle \tau \rangle \langle \sigma \rangle = \bigcup_{\tau^i \in \langle \tau \rangle} \tau^i \langle \sigma \rangle = \bigcup_{\tau^i \in \langle \tau \rangle} \langle \sigma \rangle \tau^i = \langle \sigma \rangle \langle \tau \rangle.$$

By a theorem we proved and used extensively last semester, $\langle \sigma \rangle \langle \tau \rangle$ is a subgroup of $\langle \sigma, \tau \rangle$. Also note that since τ fixes the element σ acts on and vice versa, $\langle \tau \rangle \cap \langle \sigma \rangle = 1$ trivially. Therefore, $\langle \tau \rangle \langle \sigma \rangle$ is an internal direct product, and thus

$$\langle \tau \rangle \langle \sigma \rangle \cong \langle \tau \rangle \times \langle \sigma \rangle.$$

This direct product of groups has order $|\langle \tau \rangle| \cdot |\langle \sigma \rangle| = 5 \cdot 4 = 20$, so we have that $\langle \tau, \sigma \rangle = \langle \tau \rangle \langle \sigma \rangle$ since they can both have no more than order 20, since they are subgroups of the Galois group which has order 20. We thus have $|\langle \tau, \sigma \rangle| = 20$, and thus $\langle \tau, \sigma \rangle = \text{Gal}(E/\mathbb{Q})$.